

Chapter 12 — Bhakti Yoga

भक्तियोगः : భక్తియోగము

"The Yoga of Devotion" · 20 verses · The shortest, sweetest chapter — Part II's culmination

After the overwhelming cosmic vision of Ch 11, Arjuna asks a practical question: *"Which is better — to worship You as the personal form, or as the formless Absolute?"*

Kṛṣṇa's answer is gentle and direct: **both reach the same goal, but loving the personal form is easier for embodied beings**. The chapter then paints — in just 8 verses (12.13–20) — the most beloved portrait in all the Gītā: **the qualities of the devotee dear to the Lord**. These verses are recited daily in many traditions as a kind of self-examination mirror.

Essential verses of Chapter 12

BG 12.8 Fix your mind on Me — and you shall live in Me, without doubt

मय्येव मन आधत्स्व मयि बुद्धिं निवेशय ।

निवसिष्यसि मय्येव अत ऊर्ध्वं न संशयः ॥ १२.८ ॥

మయ్యేవ మన ఆధత్స్వ మయి బుద్ధిం నివేశయ ।

నివసిష్యసి మయ్యేవ అత ఊర్ధ్వం న సంశయః ॥ ౧౨.౮ ॥

mayy eva mana ādhatsva mayi buddhiṁ niveśaya |

nivasisyasi mayy eva ata ūrdhvaṁ na saṁśayaḥ ||

"Fix your mind on Me alone, place your intellect in Me — you shall live in Me hereafter. There is no doubt."

BG 12.13–14 The portrait of the devotee dear to the Lord (first verse)

अद्वेष्टा सर्वभूतानां मैत्रः करुण एव च ।

निर्ममो निरहङ्कारः समदुःखसुखः क्षमी ॥

सन्तुष्टः सततं योगी यतात्मा दृढनिश्चयः ।

मय्यर्पितमनोबुद्धिर्यो मद्भक्तः स मे प्रियः ॥

అద్వేష్టా సర్వభూతానాం మైత్రః కరుణ ఏవ చ ।

నిర్మమో నిరహంకారః సమదుఃఖసుఖః క్షమీ ॥

సంతుష్టః సతతం యోగీ యతాత్మా దృఢనిశ్చయః ।

మయ్యర్పితమనోబుద్ధిర్యో మద్భక్తః స మే ప్రియః ॥

advēṣṭā sarva-bhūtānāṁ maitraḥ karuṇa eva ca |

nirmamo nirahaṅkāraḥ sama-duḥkha-sukhaḥ kṣamī ||

santuṣṭaḥ satataṁ yogī yatātmā dṛḍha-niścayaḥ |

mayy arpita-mano-buddhir yo mad-bhaktaḥ sa me priyaḥ ||

"One who is free of hatred toward any being, friendly and compassionate, without 'mine'-ness, without ego, equal in pain and pleasure, forgiving, ever content, disciplined, of firm resolve, with mind and intellect surrendered to Me — that devotee is dear to Me."

Word-by-Word — 12.13 (the qualities of the dear devotee)

IAST	అక్షరాలు	అక్షరాలు	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>advēṣṭā</i>	అద్వేష్టా	అద్వేష్టా	ad-VESH-taa	without hatred / non-hating
<i>sarva-bhūtānām</i>	సర్వభూతానామ్	సర్వభూతానామ్	SAR-va-bhoo-TAA-naam	toward all beings

